

A Praise of the Buddha

Buddhasya Stotra Nāma · Toh 1114 · Derge Tengyur

སངས་རྒྱལ་གྱིས་རྒྱུ་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ

Toh 1114 in the Tengyur is a devotional hymn known in Sanskrit as the Buddhasya stotra and in Tibetan as Sanggyé kyi töpa, meaning "A Praise of the Buddha." It is a short stotra, or eulogy, celebrating the virtues and deeds of the Buddha, evoking his vast acts of generosity across countless lifetimes, his mastery over the mind, and his compassionate engagement with the world to liberate beings from suffering. The text opens with vivid verses recounting how the Buddha gave away his very heads, eyes, flesh, and blood without measure, and how he subdued the swift and wandering mind to overcome the māras and the ocean of misfortune. Belonging to the class of praise literature within the Tengyur, it was translated into Tibetan and revised by the renowned monk and great editor-translator Rinchen Zangpo, one of the most celebrated figures of the early second diffusion of Buddhism in Tibet.

Translated previously, and revised and finalized by the great editor and translator, the monk Rinchen Zangpo.

In the Indian language: Buddhasya stotra nāma. In the Tibetan language: A Praise of the Buddha.

Homage to Mañjuśrī in his youthful form.

He who offered up his heads, surpassing in their measure even Mount Meru,
He who gave away hundreds of eyes more numerous than the stars,
He who likewise gave his flesh and blood vast as the earth and ocean —
To the Blessed One, the Buddha, who practiced such austerities, I always bow.

He who brought under his mastery a mind like lightning, darting and swift,
He who truly liberated the three worlds from the ocean of misfortune and harm,

He who, to vanquish the māra of existence, once again enters into becoming —

To the Blessed One, the Buddha, who practiced such austerities, I always bow.

He who, bound by the vow of compassion and rejoicing for the sake of sentient beings,

Was dismissed from thought by the foremost lords of the three worlds of gods, demigods, and men,

He who, with supreme tenderness toward hungry creatures, fully gave his body —

To the Blessed One, the Buddha, who practiced such austerities, I always bow.

He who, to swiftly rescue and protect sentient beings seized by compassion,
Dwelt in the wilderness as livestock, fish, and deer,
Enduring fatigue and exhaustion for long ages and giving away his very bodies —

To the Blessed One, the Buddha, who practiced such austerities, I always bow.

He who, to serve as medicine for the bodily illness of many sentient beings,
Driven by loving-kindness or compassion for wandering beings, in the most extreme wilderness of famine,

Found the body of a great elephant in the forests and applied it to relieve the suffering of others —

To the Blessed One, the Buddha, who practiced such austerities, I always bow.

He who, in the hour when the thorn of famine pierced and stung,
Cut off the precious jewel born atop his head and gave it away to remain with brahmins, lords of men, and others,

And who in all circumstances, with equal lightness of heart, acted entirely for the sake of sentient beings —

To the Blessed One, the Buddha, who practiced such austerities, I always bow.

He who dwelt separately in different forests, attained through auspicious dreams the power of true speech,

Was born on the lion throne of those who practice what is beneficial — mother, king, and benefactors of others —

As a being with six tusks who suckled two young, for the sake of all migrating beings and all phenomena —

To the Blessed One, the Buddha, who practiced such austerities, I always bow.

He who, through the qualities of generosity, moral discipline, good qualities, patience, power, diligence, and meditative concentration,

And through the qualities of loving-kindness and compassion that renounce what is equal to supreme wisdom,

Attained and truly realized the station of a caravan leader guiding beings dwelling in remote wilderness —

To the Blessed One, the Buddha, who practiced such austerities, I always bow.

This Praise of the Buddha composed by the noble Utpalavārṇā is complete.

This great place of great renown, the city of Yambu in Nepal: the master of sound, the venerable...

Translator's Notes

- The final line is fragmentary, breaking off mid-sentence with a proper name incomplete in the source text. The colophon identifies the translation and editorial work as that of the great Lotsāwa Rinchen Zangpo, one of the most celebrated Tibetan translators of the early second diffusion period.

The verse about the six-tusked elephant refers to the *Ṣaḍdanta Jātaka*, in which the bodhisattva was born as a six-tusked white elephant who gave his tusks to a hunter sent by a jealous queen. The phrase "born as a being with six tusks who suckled two young" is a somewhat compressed reference to this well-known birth story.

The attribution "composed by the noble Utpalavārṇā" at the colophon is notable: Utpalavārṇā is ordinarily known as a female arhat disciple of the Buddha, and her authorship of a stotra in Sanskrit is unusual. The attribution is accepted as given in the text without emendation.

The phrase rendered "dismissed from thought by the foremost lords" is doctrinally dense and the Tibetan is slightly unusual; it may indicate that the bodhisattva transcended or abandoned conceptual thinking even as regarded by the chief beings of the three worlds, i.e., his practice was beyond their comprehension or approval. This reading is reflected in the translation.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.